

CloudScale IT Security: Enterprise Slack & Acceptable Use Policy

Corporate Security Standard (SEC-109) | Data Classification & Workspace Governance

1. Workspace Data Classification & Prohibited Content

To comply with SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, and GDPR certifications, employees must strictly observe data sharing boundaries in Slack:

- **Strictly Prohibited:** Unencrypted API keys, database credentials, AWS/GCP service account tokens, customer payment details (credit cards/CVV), and unmasked personally identifiable information (PII).
- **Credential Detection:** Slack DLP automatically scans all outbound messages and file uploads. Detected secrets are instantly quarantined and reported to #security-alerts.

2. Message & File Retention Schedules

- **Public Channel Messages:** Retained for **365 days (1 year)** before automated purge, unless tagged under an indefinite legal litigation hold.
- **Private Channel Messages:** Retained for **180 days (6 months)**. Extensions require VP approval for audit compliance.
- **Direct Messages (DMs & Group DMs):** Retained for **90 days (3 months)** and purged automatically on day 91.
- **Uploaded Files & Document Snippets:** Retained for 180 days in Slack storage; ingested Pinecone vector embeddings persist until explicitly purged.

3. Channel Management & Lifecycle

- **Public by Default:** All cross-departmental collaboration must occur in public channels (e.g., #eng-architecture, #cloud-devops) to preserve institutional knowledge.
- **Stale Channel Archival:** Channels with no message activity for 90 consecutive days are automatically archived on the 1st of each month.
- **Guest User Policy:** Multi-channel guests are permitted for contractors only with an executive sponsor and signed NDA. Guest accounts automatically expire after 180 days.